

# Artificial Intelligence

## Uncertainty

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## 1 From Logic to Probability Theory

Consider:

$$Toothache \implies Cavity$$

Not all patients with toothaches have cavities. How about:

$$Toothache \implies Cavity \vee GumProblem \vee Abscess \dots$$

We'd need large list after the dots. Try causal direction:

$$Cavity \implies Toothache$$

But not all cavities hurt. Logic fails to deal with complex domains like medical diagnosis due to:

- **Exhaustivity** (laziness). Too many antecedents or consequents to list.
- **Theoretical ignorance**. Rare to have complete logical theory of nontrivial domain.
- **Practical ignorance**. Even with a complete domain theory, hard to measure all the necessary inputs (medical tests, etc.)

We need to deal with uncertain knowledge, with **degrees of belief**. For that, we use probability theory.

## 2 What do probabilities mean?



## 3 What do probabilities mean?

| Proposition | Agent 1's belief | Agent 2 bets            | Agent 1 bets      | Agent 1 payoffs for each outcome |             |             |                  |
|-------------|------------------|-------------------------|-------------------|----------------------------------|-------------|-------------|------------------|
|             |                  |                         |                   | $a, b$                           | $a, \neg b$ | $\neg a, b$ | $\neg a, \neg b$ |
| $a$         | 0.4              | \$4 on $a$              | \$6 on $\neg a$   | -\$6                             | -\$6        | \$4         | \$4              |
| $b$         | 0.3              | \$3 on $b$              | \$7 on $\neg b$   | -\$7                             | \$3         | -\$7        | \$3              |
| $a \vee b$  | 0.8              | \$2 on $\neg(a \vee b)$ | \$8 on $a \vee b$ | \$2                              | \$2         | \$2         | -\$8             |
|             |                  |                         |                   | -\$11                            | -\$1        | -\$1        | -\$1             |

All I see is the code.

```
this_is = a_python_code_block
if it_is_not_processed:
    it_is_likely_within_a_column_env
if not_in_colmn_env:
    there_is_another_problem
```

## 4 Probabilities are about our uncertain knowledge.

"80% chance (probability 0.8) patient with a toothache has a cavity."

- Out of all the situations that are indistinguishable from the current situation **as far as our knowledge goes**, the patient will have a cavity in 80% of them.
- Belief could come from statistical data, or domain theory, or combination of sources.

There is no uncertainty in the actual world. The patient either has a cavity or does not. Probabilities refer to our knowledge of the world state, not the actual world state.<sup>[fn]</sup>

If our knowledge changes, e.g., we find out patient has history of gum disease, we make a different statement. Here is a .

"Given patient has a history of gum disease and a toothache, 40% chance patient has gum disease."

<sup>[fn]</sup>: Footnote <sup>[fn2]</sup>: <https://this/isn't/real>

## 5 Decision-Theoretic Agents

Decision theory = probability theory + utility theory

**function** DT-AGENT(*percept*) **returns** an *action*

**persistent:** *belief\_state*, probabilistic beliefs about the current state of the world  
*action*, the agent's action

update *belief\_state* based on *action* and *percept*

calculate outcome probabilities for actions,

given action descriptions and current *belief\_state*

select *action* with highest expected utility

given probabilities of outcomes and utility information

**return** *action*

Each action, *a*, leads to a probability distribution over outcomes, or "result states":

$$P(\text{RESULT}(a) = s') = \sum_{s \in S} P(s)P(s' \mid s, a)$$

And each outcome state has a utility. A rational decision-theoretic agent chooses the action that maximize expected utility, that is:

$$\underset{a}{\operatorname{argmax}} \sum_{s' \in S} P(\text{RESULT}(a) = s')U(s')$$

## 6 Propositions and Events

An **event**, which we denote with  $\phi$  here, is a set of possible worlds, some subset of  $\Omega$ , or set of  $\omega$ , e.g., the event "doubles" contains the 6 boxed elements  $\omega$ :

|                        |                                                      |                                                      |                                                      |                                                      |                                                      |                                                      |
|------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
|                        | <span style="border: 1px solid black;">(1, 1)</span> | (2, 1)                                               | (3, 1)                                               | (4, 1)                                               | (5, 1)                                               | (6, 1)                                               |
|                        | (1, 2)                                               | <span style="border: 1px solid black;">(2, 2)</span> | (3, 2)                                               | (4, 2)                                               | (5, 2)                                               | (6, 2)                                               |
|                        | (1, 3)                                               | (2, 3)                                               | <span style="border: 1px solid black;">(3, 3)</span> | (4, 3)                                               | (5, 3)                                               | (6, 3)                                               |
| table/header-rows={1}} | (1, 4)                                               | (2, 4)                                               | (3, 4)                                               | <span style="border: 1px solid black;">(4, 4)</span> | (5, 4)                                               | (6, 4)                                               |
|                        | (1, 5)                                               | (2, 5)                                               | (3, 5)                                               | (4, 5)                                               | <span style="border: 1px solid black;">(5, 5)</span> | (6, 5)                                               |
|                        | (1, 6)                                               | (2, 6)                                               | (3, 6)                                               | (4, 6)                                               | (5, 6)                                               | <span style="border: 1px solid black;">(6, 6)</span> |

## 7 Analysis of Medical Screening Example

$$\begin{aligned}P(C = 1) &= \frac{1}{100} \\P(C = 0) &= \frac{99}{100} \\P(T = 1 \mid C = 1) &= \frac{90}{100} \\P(T = 0 \mid C = 1) &= \frac{10}{100} \\P(T = 1 \mid C = 0) &= \frac{3}{100} \\P(T = 0 \mid C = 0) &= \frac{97}{100}\end{aligned}$$

If we screen someone, probability that they test positive (notice use of product rule:  $P(a, b) = P(a \mid b)P(b)$  and rule 2nd Kolmogorov axiom  $P(x \vee y) = P(x) + P(y) - P(x \wedge y)$ ):

$$\begin{aligned}P(T = 1) &= P(T = 1 \mid C = 0)P(C = 0) + P(T = 1 \mid C = 1)P(C = 1) \\&= \frac{3}{100} \times \frac{99}{100} + \frac{90}{100} \times \frac{1}{100} \\&= \frac{387}{10,000} \\&= .0387\end{aligned}$$

If someone tests positive, probability they have cancer :